

NEW RULES FOR STREETS, ROADS & DRIVEWAYS

WHAT IS BEING PROPOSED

One new section of the zoning code covering streets, roads, and driveways. It replaces the Town's Road, Driveway and Entrance Ordinance adopted in 2020.

THE MAIN IDEA

The old rules used a single standard for every road, so a quiet gravel lane had to meet the same specifications as a village street.

The new rules sort roads into ten kinds — from Main Street at the busiest end, through village and neighborhood streets, out to rural roads and narrow country lanes. Each kind has standards that fit the kind of place it runs through. **Country lanes get to stay narrow.**

DOES ANYTHING ABOUT MY ROAD OR DRIVEWAY HAVE TO CHANGE?

No. Nothing you own has to be changed, widened, or rebuilt because this passes.

Every existing road and driveway may stay exactly as it is. The new standards apply only when:

- a brand-new road is built,
- an existing road is rebuilt from the ground up, or
- a driveway grows to serve more than two homes.

Ordinary upkeep — grading, patching, repaving, replacing a culvert — is not affected.

WHAT IF MY DRIVEWAY SOMEDAY SERVES MORE HOMES?

Once a driveway serves more than two homes, it counts as a road and has to be built to the standard for its kind. How much work that means now depends on how much is being built:

- **Three or four homes** — only the safety essentials: the driving surface, drainage, clear sight lines where it meets the road, and room for a fire truck to turn around. No sidewalk, no curbing, no wider strip of land.
- **Five or more homes**, a subdivision, or a road you want the Town to take over — the full standard for that kind of road.

Every road in Town has already been assigned its kind, and that list is part of the proposed code. So the answer is settled in advance: no one has to wait on a ruling, and no Town Meeting vote is needed when the time comes.

TREES ALONG VILLAGE STREETS

On village and neighborhood streets, healthy mature trees beside the road are now protected. When the Town or a builder digs there, the work has to avoid the tree's roots where it reasonably can, and a tree that must come out has to be replaced. Utility companies are asked to give notice, work around the roots where they can, and put things back.

The full Article, the list of every road with its assigned kind, and a map of the Town are in the draft Code. Comments are welcome at the hearing or in writing to the Planning Board.